

INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE

LT03

Unit 3 Elements of crime and mystery

Mark scheme

January 2025

Version:1.0 Final



2 5 1 X L T 0 3 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

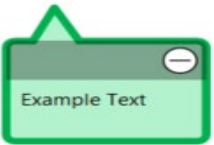
Using the mark bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 6–8. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Incorrect		Toolbar Tooltip: Incorrect		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text - text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The assessment objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 18 years old so we are judging their skills at the end of Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21–25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	- Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task. At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
	AO2	- Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. - Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16–20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	- Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response. At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.
	AO2	- Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	- Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. - Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11–15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6–10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1–5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Macbeth*

‘Women are presented as being the instigators of all crimes in *Macbeth*.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Macbeth* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the witches who awaken the fateful royal ambition within Macbeth
- Macbeth’s early decision that they ‘will proceed no further in this business’
- Lady Macbeth’s taunting her husband into action and framing of the servants
- Lady Macbeth’s suicide which could be seen as a type of crime against the self
- Hecate’s fury that her role in Macbeth’s crimes has been overlooked
- an alternative view might be Macbeth’s hiring of the murderers to kill Banquo and Fleance, and his decision to kill Macduff’s family
- Macduff’s abandoning of his wife and children as a contributing factor to their deaths.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the play opening with the three witches plotting to meet with Macbeth
- the repeated use of imagery associated with gender in Lady Macbeth’s soliloquy
- Lady Macbeth’s earlier domination in terms of speech, eg Act 1 Scene 7
- the night time setting of Act 5 Scene 1 which symbolises Lady Macbeth’s spiritual darkness
- the symbolism used to present the witches as only mediums of fate or prophecies
- Macbeth being alone on stage when he becomes resolute in his decision to kill Duncan.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of dramatic method.

0	2
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Coleridge: *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*

‘In *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*, the punishment far exceeds the crime.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the Mariner’s crime which in a literal sense is simply the shooting of a bird
- the Mariner’s punishments; his catalogue of sufferings and his eternal wanderings which could be seen as an extreme response to the shooting of a bird
- an alternative view might be the element of criminal responsibility assigned to the Mariner
- the Mariner’s destruction of the natural world from an eco-critical perspective, his ‘crime’ against nature as shown by ‘who loveth best/All things both great and small’
- a religious reading which would see the albatross as symbolic of Christ, and the Mariner’s eternal punishment
- the many others who are ‘punished’ as a result of the Mariner’s crime, including the crew’s deaths, the Pilot’s Boy who goes insane and the wedding guest who misses his celebrations.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of extreme and hostile settings to reflect the horror of his punishment
- the use of repeated images of blood and death which emphasise the extreme punishment the Mariner and his crew receive
- the albatross as an allegorical figure of Christianity and redemption
- the use of the frame narrative and the wedding guest’s reaction to the Mariner’s crime and his punishment
- the lengthy gothic imagery used to depict the extreme suffering of the Mariner at sea, in contrast to the rather terse line describing the crime
- the shooting of the albatross as the climactic moment of the poem which serves to present its significance as a crime.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	3
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Robert Browning: *Selected Poems*

‘Ultimately, Browning’s poems lack any sense of restoration to order.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

In your answer refer to ‘The Pied Piper of Hamelin’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Browning’s *Selected Poems* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the innocent children stolen by the Piper who end up as ‘alien’ people in Transylvania as punishment for their parents’ crimes
- the challenge to the social order presented by the narrator of ‘The Laboratory’
- the ending of ‘Porphyria’s Lover’ which sees the narrator mocking God’s power
- the Duke’s search for a new wife in ‘My Last Duchess’
- an alternative view might be the ending to ‘The Pied Piper’ where the narrator and Willy pledge to keep their promises
- the Mayor and the corporation who are punished for their greed by the Piper
- the Patriot’s belief that he is going to God and will be safer there.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the return to the narrative present at the end of ‘The Pied Piper’ to a time where promises are kept and order is presumably restored
- the ending of ‘Count Gismond’ which sees the narrator easily tell a lie, casting doubt on the veracity of her narrative
- the repeated imagery of heads on shoulders in ‘Porphyria’s Lover’
- the cyclical structure of ‘My Last Duchess’ which sees the Duke continue to act with impunity
- the future tense used to describe the crime in ‘The Laboratory’ which means the consequences of the crime are unknown
- the parallel imagery in ‘The Patriot’.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	4
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Charles Dickens: *Oliver Twist*

Discuss the significance of the settings as backdrops for crime in *Oliver Twist*.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Oliver Twist* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the workhouse which is used to present the social crimes against the children who are starving and maltreated
- Fagin's den which is blackened with age and decay but is nonetheless a preferable home to the workhouse
- Oliver's return to Fagin's den which is used to present crime as inescapable
- The Three Cripples which acts as a place of sinister and immoral business and where there is no sense of 'honour among thieves'
- Newgate Prison as a horrific and fearful place of punishment
- the romanticised and almost dreamlike depiction of the Brownlow house, perhaps implying the improbability of sanctuary.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the social realism created through the extensive details of Victorian London
- the use of the weather to help create a dismal and murky atmosphere through the repeated reference to rain, fog and the cold
- the use of the crumbling and neglected buildings such as the workhouse which symbolise the neglect of the social institutions that have failed those living within them
- the novel's ending which sees Fagin in the condemned cell of Newgate Prison
- the ironic tone of the narrator when describing the 'virtues' of the workhouse
- the stark contrast between the dark and dangerous settings associated with poverty and the beauty of the Brownlow and Maylie houses.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	5
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Edgar Allan Poe: *Collected Stories*

‘The crimes in the short stories of Edgar Allan Poe are too extreme to be believable.’

With reference to ‘The Fall of the House of Usher’ and at least one other story, how do you respond to this statement?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Poe’s *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the hasty burying of Madeline to avoid the doctor examining her body which leads to her being buried alive
- Madeline’s climbing from her tomb despite her debilitating illness and her possibly deliberate attack on her twin brother in her dying moments
- an alternative view could be that the crime in ‘The Tell-Tale Heart’ is clearly a result of the narrator’s psychosis and therefore believable
- the violence against animals in ‘The Black Cat’ which is often depicted as the first steps into criminality for many sociopaths
- the simplicity of the crime in ‘The Purloined Letter’
- the murderer in ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ is proved to be an orang-outang, which could be seen as extreme or believable.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the creation of an intensely gothic setting in the House of Usher itself
- the supernatural mirroring of the noises Madeline makes while escaping the tomb in the narrator’s telling of the story ‘Mad Trist of Sir Launcelot Canning’
- the detailed first-person account of the burying of Madeline which informs the reader precisely how impossible escape from the tomb would be
- the opening of ‘The Murders in the Rue Morgue’ which gives credulity to the story by focusing on the rational and analytical mind of Dupin
- the close attention paid to Dupin’s reasoning and evidence for finding the orang-outang guilty
- the use of the first person, introspective narrative voice in ‘The Tell-Tale Heart’
- the reference to ‘The Murders of Rue Morgue’ at the start of ‘The Purloined Letter’ which allows Poe to draw an explicit contrast between the outrageous orang-outang murders and the more mundane theft of a letter.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	6
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Robert Louis Stevenson: *Collected Stories*

‘The criminals in Stevenson’s stories are characterised by a dissatisfaction with their everyday lives.’

Discuss the presentation of Stevenson’s criminals in the light of this statement.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Stevenson’s *Collected Stories* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Jekyll’s concealment of his ‘pleasures’ which leads to his committing to a duplicitous life
- Jekyll’s desire to transform into Hyde because of the ‘dryness of a life of study’
- Macfarlane who is prepared to commit crimes in order to gain powerful friends
- Markheim’s ‘thirst for pleasure’ that leads to his criminality
- an alternative view might be that Hyde is described as pure evil and many of his crimes are without motive
- Fettes who is tricked into criminal behavior and desires a normal life
- Villon’s crimes which appear to be motivated by survival.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of Jekyll’s full statement of the case to allow a first-person account of his feelings of dissatisfaction
- the frame narrative in ‘The Body Snatcher’ which presents how well Macfarlane has profited from his criminal activity
- the use of the dialogue between Markheim and the visitant which allows Stevenson to explore Markheim’s motives
- the night time and winter setting of ‘A Lodging for the Night’ which presents Villon as needing lodgings to survive
- the comic ending of ‘A Lodging for the Night’ which seems to present Villon as satisfied with his life.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of relevant argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 7

Agatha Christie: *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd*

‘A simple detective story, murder, inquest and suspicion falling on everyone in turn!’

To what extent do you agree with the view that *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* is no more than a simple detective story?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the use of recognisable conventions from the genre such as the locked room setting of the murder
- the exotic and sensational nature of the murder weapon: the Tunisian dagger
- the comic depiction of Inspector Davis used as an entertaining contrast to Poirot’s almost transcendent insight
- Poirot who ‘has done the most wonderful things’ and fits the role perfectly of the ‘super detective’
- the reasonably large number of suspects, all of whom are guilty of their own crime
- an alternative interpretation might be the clichéd inclusion of a suspicious butler in Parker
- explicit references made to the reading of ‘detective fiction’ and other famous literary detectives which seem to imply Christie is celebrating the genre.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the way the narrative is structured through the precise timings and the inclusion of diagrams and notes which allow the reader to act as detective
- the complete denouement offered through ‘Poirot’s Little Reunion’ and ‘Apologia’
- the use of an unreliable narrator who keeps back information to maintain suspense
- the inclusion of ‘Apologia’, where Christie reveals her crafting of the murder scene
- the poetic justice created through Dr Sheppard’s suicide following the same modus operandi as his first victim
- the dramatic irony present in the introduction of Poirot as a ‘retired hairdresser’
- the celebratory, self-reflexive nature of the text.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	8
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Qiu Xiaolong: *Death of a Red Heroine*

Consider the significance of 1990s Shanghai as a setting for murder in *Death of a Red Heroine*.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Death of a Red Heroine* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the chronic housing shortage in Shanghai which leads to resentment and suspicion of those living there
- the severe shortage of private phones in Shanghai which makes privacy difficult and allows the murder to be investigated
- Guan Hongyin who is considered a 'red heroine' because she is a Model Citizen of the People's Republic of China
- Chen who must conduct his investigations cautiously, so as not to offend the powerful political upper classes who control the police
- the killer's identity as HCC (High Cadre Children) which allows him to operate with seeming impunity
- the reference to Overseas Chinese Lu and his restaurant with Russian girls which presents the moral corruption beneath the Communist ideals.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the use of the densely populated city and corruption of political and social institutions to replicate the 'hard-boiled' crime genre
- the key characters who all represent conflicting political forces
- the opening sentence which gives a precise reference to where the body is found
- Guan Hongyin who is symbolic of the Communist high standard of a hard-working, selfless individual and whose murder shows the corruption of the political setting
- the repeated references to Tiananman Square which put the murder in a precise historical time
- Wu Xiaoming who is identified as the killer early in the narrative but whose position as HCC protects him against prosecution.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	9
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Kate Atkinson: *When Will There Be Good News?*

Discuss the view that Atkinson's female protagonists challenge typical representations of women within crime literature.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *When Will There Be Good News?* through the lens of **crime and mystery**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- Joanna Hunter who kills both her captors and doesn't require rescue
- the lack of any romantic resolution for Jackson and Louise
- Louise who is vengeful and unforgiving and uninterested in domestic matters
- Atkinson's use of Reggie as an effective and determined detective and a character who saves Jackson's life
- an alternative view might be Louise's desire for a 'Utopian nowhere' where 'women walked without fear', which reflects that most of the violence in the novel is done by men to women
- the suffering of female characters such as Reggie who is regularly victimised and suffers explicitly and Alison Needler who is traumatised and silenced
- Atkinson's use of the stereotypical 'femme fatale' character in Jackson's wife Tessa.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the dichotomous imagery used to present Joanna's killing of John and Peter while simultaneously singing nursery rhymes to the baby
- Atkinson's focus on Joanna's strength rather than her suffering by comparing her to a heroine and a warrior queen
- the use of Louise's perspective on the victims of Andrew Decker to present them as courageous
- the inclusion of the chapter and title 'Reggie Chase. Girl Detective'
- the use of Jackson's view of Joanna which is highly influenced by her gender; 'Madonna', 'goddess', 'veiled' and 'avenging angel'
- the ending which focuses on Reggie and Joanna's domestic harmony
- the contrast between Alison's life before and after her ex-husband's attack.

Given that this is a **closed book** exam, references to the text may be generalised as well as specific.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.